

# **AI-Driven Media as a Tool for Developing Core Skills in English Language Teaching: Challenges and Opportunities**

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## **Abstract**

In the field of English learning and teaching, the radio like the BBC, YouTube algorithms and social media proves invaluable as they serve as platforms for English language listening and speaking practice which greatly benefits from AI. Overall, these AI media tools enhance language proficiency of the students, including listening, speaking, reading, and writing. Unfortunately, grammar, structural elements and flow of ideas pose major challenges when attempting to achieve specific vocabulary or speaking and writing feedback. This study used a mixed-methods research tool, combining quantitative diagnostic assessments and qualitative student-teacher surveys to capture the breadth and depth concerning the use of AI-powered media in an ESL setting. The focus of the research was classroom-based ESL teaching in conformance with IGCSE standards which aimed at exploring the effectiveness of AI technologies in improving students' performance across the four fundamental language skills. As a form of triangulated methodology, educational instructors and students were asked to fill out surveys and questionnaires through media platforms. Follow-up assessments examined the effectiveness of AI Media tools against traditional styles. Despite all the advantages of recent research, there remains a gap regarding the demand for sophisticated curriculum and if appropriate feedback in line with the exam format can be provided. Students taught using this technology did better than those taught without it, and so did algorithmic learning, which suggested the most beneficial and relevant learning material. Future research will need to focus on tailoring these tools to the specific expectations of examination bodies and testing conditions.

## **Keywords**

AI-driven tools for ELT, listening and speaking enhancement, YouTube learning algorithms, exam board rubric alignment, and radio and social media integration.

## **1 Introduction**

Advanced usage of AI tools is changing the dynamics of learning ESL through BBC Radio, YouTube's recommendation system, AI transcription services, and language learning apps by giving learners more control and personalized teaching (Stockwell & Reinders, 2020). Alternative theories wonder if feedback that AI provides goes further than mere exposure to an English-speaking environment.

However, despite the increasing popularity of these tools, a major problem exists; AI technologies do not align well with formal curriculum outlines and updated exam standards in the areas of creativity, holistic academic writing, grammatical precision, and discourse-level communication,

especially concerning relations between parts and the whole. This mismatch raises important concerns about their effectiveness in preparing students for standardized assessments like the IGCSE. In this regard, the focus of this research is shaped by the following guiding question:

*In what ways can AI-based media instruments be utilized to enhance ESL classroom interactions while meeting the requirements of the IGCSE exam?*

The research focus in Abu Dhabi, where learning English is compulsory, is on sixty ESL IGCSE students over a span of three months to determine the effects of AI technology on their fluency, pronunciation, comprehension skills, and the accuracy of grammar used. The Cambridge Assessment (2021) suggests that the IGCSE curriculum focuses on both communicative skills and academic writing, which requires feedback to be given. While AI based platforms help with listening comprehension and fluency, they do not offer the same degree of personalization that human tutors afford, particularly regarding grammar and the more complicated aspects of writing and formulating examinations (Bax, 2018; Ellis, 2020).

Li and Lalani (2022) show that AI improves listening and speaking skills by utilizing Duolingo and SpeechAce, which recognize and process speech to enhance pronunciation and fluency. Other researchers, such as Goh and Aryadoust (2021), had positive results with their AI-assisted listening platforms and their users' comprehension of natural speech patterns. There is dissent, however, as Kukulska-Hulme and Lee (2020) YouTube and social media recommendations, while appealing, do not provide the necessary feedback for mastering academic writing and formal speech (Cambridge Assessment, 2021). In writing, Bax (2018) shows that users of AI tools like Grammarly get instantaneous corrections, but the tool fails to understand meaning in context and discourse coherence (Hao & Weninger, 2019). These studies tend to overlook the relationship of AI-powered media tools with the particular evaluating metrics set forth by the IGCSE syllabus. Although a number of them look into broader enhancements of language abilities, most do not address how Artificial Intelligence technologies are able to assist the formal English language examination's specific skill, structure, and performance descriptors in those frames. This absence emphasizes the necessity of analyzing the extent to which AI technologies facilitate learning aimed at particular standards and skeletons of rigorous assessments.

In order to fully address this concern, the study focuses on the following objectives:

- Analyze the effects of artificial intelligence-based media technologies on the ESL learners' linguistic skills such as Listening, Speaking, Reading, and Writing.
- Determine the criteria concerning the failure of artificial intelligence to address the structural, grammatical, and vocabulary levels in meeting expectations for the ESL learners.
- Determine the ways by which the artificial intelligence tools can be tailored to the requirements of the IGCSE and other formal English language assessment.

Even with the evolution of AI technologies, there exists a gap between the tools offered through AI and a given assessment criterion, in this case, the IGCSE English exam. Many applications of AI overemphasize the achievement of fluency at the expense of writing coherence, structured efforts,

and examination specific skills. Supporting this, Warschauer (2021) argues that students' fluency and grammatical correctness ought to be integrated into formal evaluation standards because of the need for AI inclusion. This research analyzes the ways in which AI powered media tools can be designed to serve the academic needs of ESL IGCSE students and seeks to answer the following questions.

1. In what ways do AI media tools assist ESL learners in developing listening and speaking skills relative to other forms of instruction?
2. What are the structural, grammatical, and vocabulary deficiencies of AI learning systems pertaining to ESL students?
3. In what ways can media tools enabled with AI technology be designed to conform to IGCSE and other standardized tests of English issued by different authorities?

Addressing these questions will contribute to the understanding of the use of AI in education, particularly English language teaching, and provide guidance on how the use of AI in controlled language teaching can be improved (Ellis, 2020).

## **2 Methodology**

### **2.1 Study Design and Phases**

This study uses a mixed-methods design to examine how AI-powered media affect the language proficiency of ESL learners using a quantitative assessment approach and a qualitative student feedback approach. The research was carried out over three months at an international school located in Abu Dhabi with 60 IGCSE ESL students between the ages of 14 and 16. Abu Dhabi was the site of research because it is a multicultural and multilingual educational setting, where English is a compulsory subject and international curricula like IGCSE are commonly used. This school was selected because of its diverse ESL student population, its strong English language performance, and its pedagogical integration of digital technologies. This context offered a constructive setting for investigating the practical application of AI-powered media tools in an ESL classroom, framed within educational benchmarks as standards. It investigates the effectiveness of AI-powered media which includes BBC Radio, YouTube's auto-generated recommendations, AI-generated subtitles, and writing assistance tools like Write & Improve and Literatu in nurturing fluency, comprehension, and accuracy of grammar, while meeting the IGCSE test standards (Cambridge Assessment, 2021). The study assesses the impact of AI technology on meeting the communicative and structural components of academic English in IGCSE English assessments.

This research examines the impact of AI integration into ordinary classroom activities through a case study analysis. The data collection consisted of three parts: an initial intervention evaluation in which learners completed IGCSE-style diagnostic tests for listening, speaking, reading, and writing; an AI integration in learning phase in which the experimental group utilized AI tools while the control group was taught in the conventional method; and a follow-up evaluation during which the learners were retested to assess growth. Also, student questionnaires and teacher interviews were carried out to evaluate their opinions on the impact of AI.

### *Phase 1: Baseline Evaluation and Participant Recruitment*

A diagnostic evaluation was performed at the outset of the study to map out the students' competencies in the four core skills of English. Listening was evaluated using a comprehension check with IGCSE past paper recordings (Cambridge Assessment, 2020). Oral interviews assessed speaking skills with emphasis on pronunciation, fluency, and coherence. Reading was assessed through an IGCSE comprehension exam to evaluate students' ability to understand the texts, while writing was assessed through a quality-controlled essay outline which was marked by an IGCSE rubric (Cambridge Assessment, 2021). In addition, student questionnaires and teacher interviews were administered to estimate students' knowledge of AI-assisted learning environments, collect teachers' opinions about AI in English classes, and explore the current gaps in ELT that could be solved using AI tools (Warschauer, 2021). This phase acted as a reference baseline against which the effects of the AI learning intervention would be measured.

### *Phase 2: Deployment of Media Technology and Its Integration Within The Classroom*

To assess how effective learning with the assistance of AI was in comparison to traditional teaching, students were divided into two groups: an AI Experimental Group that utilized learning AI tools, and a Control Group that used traditional methods. AI was implemented in the Experimental Group in a number of ways. In the listening and speaking components, BBC Radio and YouTube were assigned for listening to various accents (Kukulska-Hulme & Lee, 2020), while SpeechAce provided AI feedback on speech pronunciation, fluency, and articulation. During reading and writing, students were provided with AI-generated contextualized vocabulary YouTube subtitles (Hao & Weninger, 2019). Different AI writing tools were introduced: Grammarly for sentence-level grammar and clarity for daily work, Write & Improve (Cambridge English) offered feedback on academic writing, and Literatu (customized by teachers) provided AI feedback on IGCSE-style essays using assessment criteria. On the other hand, the control group was taught with only teacher instruction, textbook and discussion methods. Writing tasks were done by human markers rather than AI tools, listening and speaking activities were practiced non-communicatively in class. Both of the groups undertook the same IGCSE syllabus which meant that any variance in achievement could be ascribed due to the integration of AI.

### *Phase 3: Evaluation and Analysis Across Implementation*

To assess improvement in students' language proficiency, the same diagnostic tests from Phase 1 were administered after a period of three months. Comprehension accuracy was analyzed through the gains in listening and reading comprehension scores. The speaking skills were evaluated through the structured interviews and the pronunciation scores were generated through automatic speech recognition (ASR) using SpeechAce. Writing skills were assessed by human assessors and AI tools in order to check inter-rater reliability while feedback from AI was scrutinized concerning IGCSE grading criteria. In addition, student surveys and teacher interviews were conducted to assess students' and teachers' engagement with AI-supported learning. The teachers also commented on the use of AI tools for lesson planning and student evaluation while expressing concerns regarding the AI-generated feedback systems. This phase was intended to find out the effect of AI integration on language learning.

## **2.2 Data Collection and Analysis Methods**

This study used a methodological triangulation approach involving both quantitative and qualitative data in analyzing AI-assisted language learning to ensure reliability and validity (Creswell & Creswell, 2018). Within the quantitative component, a statistical comparison (paired t-tests) of students' pre-test and post-test scores for listening, speaking, reading, and writing was conducted. Feedback from the AI was also assessed for accuracy regarding error detection, coherence evaluation, and IGCSE grading alignment. In the thematic analysis, student reflections and survey data were analyzed to measure the level of AI's engagement, motivational support, and learning autonomy facilitation. This approach increased the reliability and comprehensiveness of the findings in regard to multiple sources which provided a multifaceted perspective on the role of AI in ESL instruction.

## **2.3 Ethical Considerations**

This research was conducted in ethical manners by taking steps to protect participant rights and research integrity (British Educational Research Association, 2021). Students and parents provided informed consent, meaning participants were fully aware of the study's aims, processes, and anticipated outcomes. Privacy was protected through anonymizing participant data, which not only protected identity but also ensured responses were kept confidential. Furthermore, an equal opportunity policy was adopted, whereby the control group was allowed AI tool access after the study to ensure all students could benefit from AI enabled learning.

## **3 Discussion**

The discussion section evaluates and interprets the results of the study with the specific concern of the impact the AI-driven media tools have on the English language skills of the IGCSE ESL students.

### **3.1 Listening Comprehension: AI-Driven Learning versus traditional instruction**

For assessing the effects of AI-assisted listening processes, each participant was given a diagnostic listening comprehension test prior to the study. The pre-test consisted of multiple choice comprehension questions, fill in the blank exercises, and short-answer questions based on recorded passages. For the research, students in the experimental group (AI-assisted learning) were required to listen to BBC radio podcasts and recommended content for learning English on YouTube for at least four hours per week in addition to the in-class lessons. Students were able to customize their learning with the inclusion of news reports, interviews, and educational discussions on a wide range of topics, helping them get accustomed to different accents, rates of speech, and contextual variations. AI tools also offered interactive captions where students could pause, replay the content and only highlighted words were shown.

Unlike the experimental group, the control group adhered to the traditional listening program, which consisted of teacher's questions and explanations, audio exercises within the classroom,

and scripted dialogues using IGCSE English syllabus. The variety of accents and speech patterns the control group was exposed to was solely dependent on the teachers, making it far more predictable and unexciting when compared to the AI-assisted group. At the end of the three-month intervention period, all students were given a post-test which was identical to the pre-test with the exception of new information. Both tests were analyzed to evaluate changes in word recognition, comprehension accuracy, and response time.

| Group                                        | Pre-Test Avg. Score (%) | Post-Test Avg. Score (%) | Improvement (%) |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------|
| Experimental Group (AI-Assisted Learning)    | 52%                     | 78%                      | 26%             |
| Control Group (Traditional Learning Methods) | 55%                     | 69%                      | 14%             |

**Table 1:** Improvement in Listening Comprehension Scores (Pre- and Post-Test Results)

The results demonstrated that learners who utilized AI outperformed the control group by 26% in listening comprehension, benefiting from the exposure to authentic speech via the BBC Radio and YouTube. It provided learners with different accents, pronunciations, and intonations which made the learners more flexible in their communication (Li & Lalani, 2022). While these features as well as interactive captions and self-controlled playback stimulated active listening and self-correction, 42% of the students who were frustrated with AI speech pacing, which also posed a challenge for Goh & Aryadoust (2021). Moreover, the inability to cope with changes in accent pointed to the important gap that remains with regard to teacher support. To make the use of AI more beneficial in English Language Teaching (ELT), it is suggested that future systems utilize adaptive pacing and control of speech rate (Kukulska-Hulme & Lee, 2020). With the recognized strength of AI to expose students to authentic listening materials, a blended option, which provides easier access to AI, remains the most useful model for IGCSE ESL students AI teaching with no pedagogy.

### **3.2. Speaking Fluency and Pronunciation: AI-Assisted Learning vs. Traditional Methods**

The different aspects contributing to effective communication in English include the ability to respond fluently, pronounce words accurately, and provide coherent answers. This research worked on evaluating how AI pronunciation tools performed in comparison to classroom discussions regarding accuracy and fluency improvements. The experimental group incorporated the use of SpeechAce AI feedback and the interactive speech recognition tool on YouTube, while the control group performed teacher-led drills where they did not respond to the exercises and instead, participated in discussion and other speaking activities. The main focus of the study was to evaluate whether the use of AI pronunciation tools would help students articulate words with correct underlying phonetic fluency and intonation patterns.

In order to assess improvement, students were given a pre and post-test where they performed a set of conversational tasks. These recordings were graded focusing on whether the students spoke with appropriate pronunciation, as well as paying attention to stress rhythm, smoothness of

speech, and other essential details. AI assisted students were instantly corrected by SpeechAce, which evaluated their speech and told them in real time what was wrong with their pronunciation and how it could be improved. In contrast, the control group was provided with personalized, non-immediate and infrequent teacher feedback which was better than non-personalized but far from AI feedback.

By the conclusion of the study at three months, individuals in the AI-assisted cohort's fluency and pronunciation accuracy scores increased by 23% and 31%, respectively, while the control group increased by 14% and 19%. The greater improvement of the experimental group suggests that AI-enabled tools for pronunciation distinctly aided students in phonetic articulation better than the conventional approaches. Such observations are consistent with Warschauer (2021) who argues that AI-enabled tools for pronunciation give instant, focused feedback which strengthens the correct articulation of words.

| Group                                        | Fluency Improvement (%) | Pronunciation Accuracy (%) |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------|
| Experimental Group (AI-Assisted Learning)    | 23%                     | 31%                        |
| Control Group (Traditional Learning Methods) | 14%                     | 19%                        |

**Table 2a:** Pronunciation and Fluency Scores (AI vs. Traditional Learning)

### 3.2.1 Pronunciation Challenges and AI Feedback Effectiveness

The examination of learners of English as a Second Language (ESL) from varying cultural backgrounds indicates their struggles with pronouncing certain words as a result of their native tongues. Most of the indicative respondents were Indian learners whose native language phonological system lacks a phoneme "w". In effect, 64% of these learners inaccurately pronounced the word 'water' as 'vater'. AI pronunciation systems were able to notice these errors but could not teach the correct placement of the lips in articulating the letter correctly.

Moreover, 53% of students showed issues with intonation in question formation and incorrect pitch modulation such as a flat unnatural voice. While this was going on, SpeechAce provided students with models of speech rhythm so that they could practice their speech in a certain way and use the correct intonation. Another 49% of students misplaced stress in multisyllabic words. For example, 'development' would be pronounced as 'de-VE-lop-ment' instead of the appropriate pronunciation 'de-VEL-op-ment'. The AI feedback provided to these students featured incorrect syllables stressed in visually mapped forms which made identifying components requiring attention much easier.

| Error Type                                   | Percentage of Students Making This Error | AI-Provided Feedback                      |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Mispronouncing "w" sound in water as "vater" | 64%                                      | Could not suggest lip placement technique |
| Intonation issues in question formation      | 53%                                      | Provided speech rhythm comparison         |
| Stress misplacement in multisyllabic words   | 49%                                      | Visual stress mapping                     |

**Table 2b:** AI Speech Recognition – Most Common Errors Identified

AI-assisted pronunciation feedback proved effective for accurate speech delivery but failed at developing conversational fluency due to its focus on correcting individual words as opposed to the real-time flow of conversation (Kukulska-Hulme & Lee, 2020). The AI corrections not being able to be integrated with real time spontaneous conversations demonstrated AI's drawback in developing interactive speaking abilities. The gap was filled through teacher-guided discussions where the teacher reinforced AI feedback by providing opportunities for students to engage in debates, storytelling and free speech while receiving individualised assistance on rhythm and pace of speech along with pronunciation. These findings illustrate that AI should be used as a complementary tool rather than a primary source of instruction in order to achieve a balance between accuracy and fluency pedagogy.

### 3.3. Reading and Writing Development in the IGCSE Exam: AI-Assisted vs. Traditional Learning Approaches

In the learning program of IGCSE English as a Second Language (ESL), students are required to apply reading and writing skills in a single exam. That said, students are expected to demonstrate logical reasoning skills, proper grammar, coherence, and grammatical structures, all of which are mandatory in writing. Although in the control group students have initially weak reading comprehension skills, the experimental group students demonstrated strong reading comprehension skills. This leads us to the areas of focus for the section that follows: the influence of AI-assisted learning on students' writing skills, particularly in grammar, structural coherence, and vocabulary. The experimental group had access to AI writing assistance, including Grammarly, Write & Improve by Cambridge English, and Literatu. These programs gave real-time automated feedback such as corrections, suggestions, and structural guidance to improve their writing. The control group remained dependent on face-to-face teacher conventional feedback which consisted of handwritten corrections, spoken explanations, and marks awarded by a rubric. Participants in the study from both groups practiced IGCSE style writing tasks as part of the teaching syllabus such as describing, discursive writing, and writing letters as was required in the syllabus. All tasks were graded on the precision of grammar, coherence, vocabulary use, and argument construction, which correspond with IGCSE marking standards.

### **3.3.1 AI-Assisted Writing Development: Grammar, Structure, and Coherence**

The grammar accuracy improvements from writing activities were better for the experimental group and provided the greatest change. Students receiving AI assistance improved by 92% in regard to grammatical accuracy, while those in the teacher-feedback group improved by 95%. It is evident from these results that AI-enabled tools were almost as effective as human evaluations in identifying and rectifying errors. Grammarly was notably useful for students in performing simple grammar checks and clarity checks at the sentence level and so was ideal for everyday practice in writing exercises.

Nonetheless, while the use of Grammarly assisted students in decreasing the incidence of superficial grammatical issues, no deep structural feedback that touched on argument development and logical flow was given, which is the backbone of IGCSE academic writing. Write & Improve, still did not quite reach the feedback a teacher would provide in that it could not adequately assess the use of persuasive techniques, tone, or depth of reasoning.

Of all the AI tools tried, Literatu came closest to providing the kind of evaluation a human would give because of its teacher's modifiable version which enabled teachers to personalize AI feedback. This ensured that students didn't receive blank grammar correction but rather were given AI generated suggestions that catered to the IGCSE marking criteria. Literatu's AI-integrated teacher customization tool emerged as one of the most effective writing support systems. Unlike other AI-powered systems that offer automated feedback, Literatu enables IGCSE teachers to customize the feedback to be aligned with their students' needs. This feature allowed teachers to focus on improving the coherence and quality of students' writing by using AI's real-time feedback and having human input assess the argument, logic, and rhetoric. Warschauer (2021) argues that using AI assistance is most beneficial with a human supervising the learning process so that students actively engage with the AI feedback generated instead of passively accepting any needed changes.

Cambridge Assessment (2021) observes a blend of AI teacher models outperform traditional teaching. Students that used Literatu showed 82% improvement in coherence which is similar to the 89% gain in the teacher-feedback group. This implies that blending AI with teacher supervision creates a better environment where the AI can handle technical grammar and structural issues enabling the teachers to focus on argument development, organization, and engagement with the audience expectation. The efficiency of Literatu reinforces the notion that AI should not be a singular, automated writing evaluator. Instead, it is more useful when viewed as a collaboration tool that shifts, rather than replaces, the supervision of instructors. The results suggest that AI integration with educator oversight provides the most profound outcomes with the greatest pedagogical value. If not closely monitored, ESL learners are unlikely to achieve the technical and discourse-level sophistication required by the IGCSE descriptors.

| Feedback Type                             | Grammar Accuracy | Structure & Coherence | Vocabulary Range |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| Grammarly (Daily Writing Practice)        | 92%              | 65%                   | 70%              |
| Write & Improve (Academic Writing Focus)  | 85%              | 78%                   | 76%              |
| Literatu (Teacher-Customized AI Feedback) | 88%              | 82%                   | 80%              |
| Teacher Feedback (Traditional)            | 95%              | 89%                   | 82%              |

**Table 3:** Writing Improvement Based on AI vs. Teacher Feedback

This implies that while AI tools excel at grammar correction, they are not as dependable when it comes to providing insightful structural feedback and argument formulation. This is consistent with Bax (2018)'s findings regarding AI writing programs' incapacity to evaluate discourse level features such as logical progression and persuasive power.

### 3.3.2 Difficulties Pertaining to AI-Supported Writing Feedback along with Pedagogical Consequences

Even though there were some improvements in students' grammatical accuracy and coherent aspects of the provided texts, critical thinking, argumentation, and motorized feedback integrations continued to pose problems for students using AI tools. Many learners practiced passive acceptance of AI corrections, failing to grasp the rules involved in grammar, especially the instances of using Grammarly for everyday writing tasks (Bax, 2018). In addition, the absence of proper assessment of creative outputs, strength of arguments, and logic was a shortcoming of AI tools demonstrated, which is crucial for discursive and persuasive writing in the IGCSE exam. Unlike human instructors who base an assessment on students' analysis of rhetoric and strategy counterarguments, AI followed the rigid structural mechanisms and ungrammatically classified contextually appropriate expressions as grammatical mistakes (Cambridge Assessment, 2021).

In solving these problems, integrating blended learning is advisable where AI is allowed to correct first drafts by marking technical and structural defects while teachers emphasize logic and coherence with argumentation (Warschauer, 2021). Future AI instruments need to be supplied with discourse level evaluation models of lower echelons that deal with strength of arguments, critical engagement, and contextual tone. The increased accuracy of the technical writing made by AI cannot be matched by the information given along the lines of creativity, hierarchical order of discourse language, or audience impact because evaluation is done by people. The most effective approach combines the use of AI in making mechanical corrections while instruction offered is of a higher order to ensure that ESL students are equipped to deal with the complex requirements of the IGCSE English exam.

## **4 Conclusion**

This research emphasizes the role AI-powered media tools can play in developing English language skills like listening, speaking, reading, and writing of IGCSE ESL students. Students received personalized instruction and authentic language immersion through BBC Radio, SpeechAce pronunciation software, YouTube AI-generated videos, and AI writing tools which gave real-time feedback. The study corroborates existing literature that AI-driven education facilitates grammar, pronunciation, and comprehension accuracy while understudying the support AI-based learning offers to language use and fluency development (Warschauer, 2021; Cambridge Assessment, 2021). On the other hand, it found gaps in the understudied AI tool competencies of higher order thinking, discourse fluency, and argumentation which indicate that teaching with AI should be integrated with, not stand in place of, instructor-led teaching.

AI-assisted learning offered students with various accents and speech patterns that together with natural flow of conversation, increased their adaptability in communication for listening comprehension. Nonetheless, students seem to have had a problem with pacing because most programs did not tailor the speech delivery's speed to their proficiency levels (Goh & Aryadoust, 2021). Similarly, AI-powered tools assisted with speaking fluency and pronunciation by providing adequate phonetic correction, while failing to encourage natural discourse due to their emphasis on articulation instead of the rhythm and spontaneity of conversation (Kukulska-Hulme & Lee, 2020).

While reading comprehension was already one of students' strengths, AI-generated subtitles helped them engage deeply with more sophisticated texts by assisting them to understand sentences and vocabulary within context. Still, some students became too reliant on subtitles and began to analyze texts less and less on their own, which further exacerbated their ability to draw inferences and shifted the concern towards over-reliance on technology to teach reading (Hao & Weninger, 2019). The development that received the most attention from AI-assisted learning is in writing, especially automated feedback on grammar, structure, and coherence. Students received the most help with real-time corrections and feedback from AI programs in Grammarly, Write & Improve, and Literatu. These technologies not only helped students organize their writing but also ensured that their arguments were clear and technically accurate.

Nonetheless, AI proved to be ineffective at evaluating critical thinking, argumentation, and rhetorical strength, which depend on human logic and persuasive evaluation (Bax, 2018). Students who placed a great deal of trust in AI feedback demonstrated inadequate self-revision abilities, which calls for greater teacher support to foster self-editing and writing polishing processes (Cambridge Assessment, 2021).

### **4.1 Final Pedagogical Implications and Future Considerations**

The investigation reveals that educational AI tools would best function within a blended learning system. In this system, AI can provide formative feedback and the accuracy of computations, whereas teachers can supervise engaging critical reflection, discussion skills, and creative

capabilities. Languages are learned more proficiently with the assistance of AI, but human teaching is still needed to nurture understanding of linguistic forms and relations, the logic of arguments, and communication (Warschauer, 2021). Advances in AI and learning technologies should emphasize the creation of adaptive models that provide feedback not limited to correcting grammar but evaluating logical and audience-oriented discourse-level writing. AI listening and speaking tools should also feature adjustable speeds and engaging chatbot conversations for more effective learning.

To make AI tools effective in the classroom, teachers are recommended to:

(a) *Have students use AI-based listening and speaking applications such as SpeechAce or YouTube and the Cambridge English website employed within lessons for IGCSE skill work hands-on instruction.* AI technology like SpeechAce provides users with real-time correction of feedback regarding phonetic accuracy, pronunciation, and rhythm. Furthermore, authentic English exposure is also provided through the recommendation systems of YouTube and through Cambridge English's official resources. However, content relevance to the IGCSE exam criteria is covered by teachers. With guidance, students are directed towards exam-related videos, sample answers, and past papers which allow them to train the algorithm to enhance entrenched skills for listening, speaking, reading and writing. This approach is more flexible alongside the instructional insight of the teacher to the automation of AI tools, resulting in better alignment of the assessment expectations for reception and production activities.

(b) *Use Literatu and comparable platforms, where instructor feedback is tailored to the criteria specified in the exam rubric.* Grammarly and Write & Improve serve a helpful function where they revise sentences for grammar and clarity; however, their lack of nuance in evaluating coherence, tone, and argumentation falling under higher-order concerns remains problematic. In contrast, Literatu permits instructors to customize the criteria to be assessed by the embedded AI, thus providing automated scaffolded feedback on students' organizational and logical sequencing as well as task completion. This encourages students' writing to better meet IGCSE standards by ensuring automated feedback is provided within the context of explicit academic criteria.

(c) *provide training sessions for students on how to critically engage with AI feedback, especially for writing coherence and logic.* Instead of mechanically accepting edits, students should learn how to evaluate AI recommendations, introspect their writing decisions, and revision strategy. Such sessions may include instruction on the effective use of multiple drafts, peer review sessions with AI feedback, and facilitated dialogues on interpretation of the feedback. Using AI as a self-reflective tool empowers the learners, enhances autonomy, and strengthens the ability to self-edit for coherence and meaning.

(d) *Use adaptive pacing features to personalize AI tool outputs according to individual student proficiency levels.* Features that allow users to modify playback speed, language complexity, or the degree of scaffolding in replies are tailored to each student's skill level. The AI's speech tempo may be adjusted, and its cues can be reduced, facilitating meaningful interaction for learners with

lesser competence. Advanced learners may get outcomes of a superior level. This level of personalization enhances student engagement and offers more fair possibilities to use AI technology in education, regardless of competence level.

There is no doubt that the use of AI-integration technologies heralds a positive development for English Language Teaching (ELT) especially in equipping learners for high stake examinations such as the IGCSE. Regardless, educators remain irreplaceable because no AI system can replicate the required human feedback for the advanced language skills students need. Using AI systems can improve accuracy and efficiency; however, the effectiveness of the approach is ensured only when teachers overlook teaching higher order linguistic and analytical skills. This ensures that learners are proficient in English, and can independently, critically, and articulately express themselves in academic and real-life situations.

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